

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



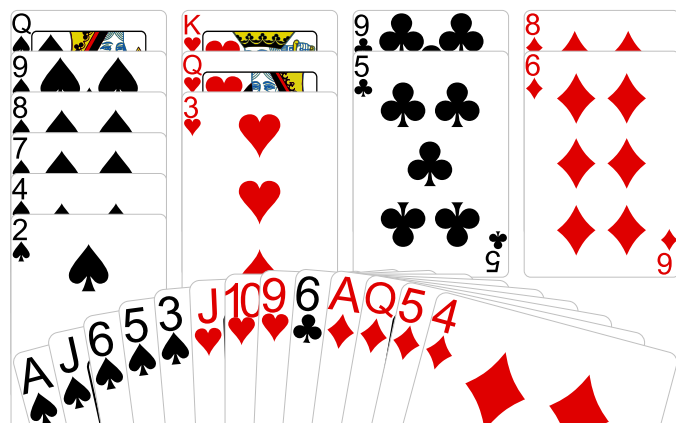
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



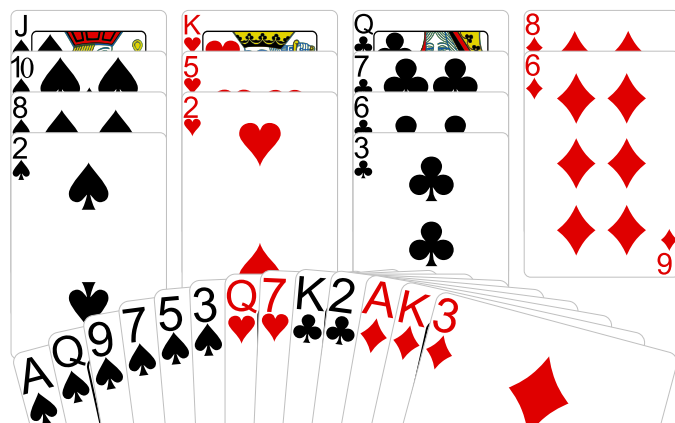
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 6 5 3 2
♥ Q
♦ Q T 8 5
♣ Q 5 4

12
8 6
14

♠ A 8 7
♥ T 9 8 6 3
♦ A 6 2
♣ A 8

N
W E
S

♠ 9 4
♥ A K 5 2
♦ K J 3
♣ K 9 6 2

♠ K J T
♥ J 7 4
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J T 7 3

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NORTH has 13 points so he must open. He has five

♥

s so he

should open 1

♥

.

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

SOUTH, with 14 points and four

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

♥

s knows there are

enough points for a game contract and at least nine

♥

s between

the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so SOUTH bids 4

♥

.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 2
♥ Q 8 4 3
♦ K 7 4
♣ K Q 2

5
12 19
4

♠ A T 6 4
♥ T 2
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ T 8 3



♠ J 7 5 3
♥ 9 7
♦ Q 8 6
♣ J 9 5 4

♠ K 9
♥ A K J 6 5
♦ A T 5
♣ A 7 6

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by East			

take the safe position and just bid 4



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EAST has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1



.

WEST has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3



.

EAST is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows WEST has 12 points at most, so she should

Deal 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K
 ♥ A 5 2
 ♦ K J 9 7 3 2
 ♣ T 7 4

7
 11 10
 12

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5



♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J T 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

♠ T
 ♥ 8 7 6 4

♦ T

♣ A K Q J 8 3 2

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NORTH passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

SOUTH naturally opens 1♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

NORTH might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the

two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4♠.

West

North

East

South

Pass

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3
♥ Q 7
♦ A K 3
♣ K 2

10
18 6
6

♠ K 6
♥ J 9 8 6
♦ Q 9 7 5 4
♣ A 5



♠ 4
♥ A T 4 3
♦ J T 2
♣ J T 9 8 4

♠ J T 8 2
♥ K 5 2
♦ 8 6
♣ Q 7 6 3

West

1 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

to 4 ♠.

North

Pass

East

2 ♠

South

Pass

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WEST has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s.

Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

EAST has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s

so he responds 2 ♠.

WEST

KNOWS

that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she

GOES

Deal 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q T 9 3 2

♥ 6

♦ 8 6 4

♣ Q 9 7

19
7 8
6

♠ A 7 4

♥ A J 8 7 2

♦ K Q J

♣ A 3



♠ J 8

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ T 6 4

♠ 6 5

♥ T 9 3

♦ A T 2

♣ K J 8 5 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set2 20

NORTH has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1

♥

rather than 2NT.

SOUTH barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four

♥

West

North

East

South

s.

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

So she responds 2

All Pass

4 ♥

4 ♥ by North

♥

.

NORTH adds SOUTH's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4

♥

.